

Danish-Swedish Farmdog Is American Kennel Club's Newest Breed

The American Kennel Club, or AKC, has named another kind of dog to its registry.

Say hello to the Danish-Swedish farmdog. Or maybe say "hej," the word for hello in Swedish and Danish.

AKC officials announced the addition to its list on January 2. The recognition means the breed now may compete for many best in show prizes. It also will probably create wider interest in the small, lively dogs. Fans of the breed are happy for the honor, but some also worry about the effect increased attention will have on the dog.

Carey Segebart is one of the people who worked to get Danish-Swedish farmdogs recognized by the AKC. "We're excited about it. We're looking forward to it," she said. She plans to show one of her own at a dog show this month near her home in the American state of Iowa.

Still, she thinks more attention can have both good and bad results for the breed. "We don't want the breed to just explode too quickly," she said.

The Danish-Swedish Farmdog Club of America says the breed, DSF for short, goes back centuries in parts of what are now Denmark, southern Sweden and some other European countries.

Fun little dogs

"They're interesting, fun little dogs," said Segebart, who has owned them since 2011 and is the club's incoming president. She said they will try anything and "succeed at most everything."

In their homelands, the dogs' main job was to control small animals called rodents. However, they also can herd, act as watchdogs and be playful with children. The club says some Danish-Swedish farmdogs have even performed in circuses.

After Denmark and Sweden became more developed in the 20th century, DSF fans decided to make the breed official in both nations. Kennel clubs there began registering the breed in 1987.

In the United States, many of the about 350 Danish-Swedish farmdogs nationwide already compete in agility, obedience or other sports that are open to all dogs, including mixed breeds.

Until now, the dogs could not enter the traditional breed-by-breed judging that leads to best in show prizes at major dog shows. They may appear later this year at two major televised events,

the National Dog Show and the AKC National Championship.

The Danish-Swedish farmdog is the AKC's 202nd breed and "a wonderful addition to a family that is able to provide it with the exercise and mental stimulation that it needs," said the AKC's Gina DiNardo.

Danish-Swedish farmdog lovers talked for several years about whether they should try to get AKC recognition and the attention that is likely to come with it, Segebart said. The number of people wanting to buy a young farmdog, or puppy, has grown quickly over the last ten years. The wait for a DSF puppy is usually a year or more, she said.

Fans of the breed worry that its appealing, relatively easy-care nature could make it quickly become too popular for its own good. They are not the first to worry. Similar concerns surround the French bulldog, which the AKC now says is the most popular breed in the country. Breeding for desired qualities has led to many health problems for the dogs.

I'm Jill Robbins

Jennifer Peltz reported this story for the Associated Press. Jill Robbins adapted it for Learning English.

Vocabulary

kennel - n. สถานที่สำหรับเลี้ยงสุนัขหรือแมวในขณะที่เจ้าของไม่อยู่; โรงเพาะพันธุ์หรือที่รับฝากเลี้ยงสุนัขหรือแมว

rodent - n. สัตว์เลี้ยงลูกด้วยนมขนาดเล็ก (เช่น หนู หนูพุก กระรอก หรือบีเวอร์) ที่มีฟันหน้าแหลมคมสำหรับแทะ

herd - v. ต้อน, รวมฝูงและเคลื่อนย้าย (กลุ่มสัตว์)

agile - adj. ว่องไว, คล่องแคล่ว, เคลื่อนไหวได้รวดเร็วและง่ายดาย

canine - adj. เกี่ยวกับสุนัข, สุนัข

stimulate - v. กระตุ้น, เร้า, ทำให้ (สิ่งมีชีวิต) ตื่นเต้นหรือสนใจในบางสิ่ง

Reading Comprehension Quiz

1. What organization recently added a new dog breed to its official registry?

- A) The European Kennel Federation
- B) The Danish-Swedish Farmdog Club of America
- C) The American Kennel Club
- D) The National Dog Show Committee

2. Which dog breed is the subject of the recent addition to the AKC registry?

- A) The Swedish Vallhund
- B) The Danish-Swedish farmdog
- C) The Norwegian Elkhound
- D) The Icelandic Sheepdog

3. When did AKC officials announce the inclusion of the new breed on their list?

- A) January 1st
- B) January 2nd
- C) This month
- D) Last year

4. According to paragraph 4, what are two main positive outcomes expected from the Danish-Swedish farmdog's AKC recognition?

- A) It will guarantee more health problems and reduce its appeal.
- B) It will allow competition for best in show prizes and create wider interest.
- C) It will limit its availability and decrease its overall popularity.
- D) It will lead to stricter breeding regulations and fewer owners.

5. What is Carey Segebart's role in the context of the Danish-Swedish farmdog's AKC recognition?

- A) She is an AKC official who made the announcement.
- B) She is a veterinarian specializing in Danish-Swedish farmdogs.
- C) She is one of the individuals who actively worked for the breed's recognition.
- D) She is a journalist reporting on the breed's new status.

6. What specific concern does Carey Segebart express about the increased attention on the Danish-Swedish farmdog?

- A) She worries the breed might become too aggressive.
- B) She fears the breed's population could decline rapidly.
- C) She doesn't want the breed to become popular too quickly.
- D) She is concerned about the financial cost of recognition.

7. According to the Danish-Swedish Farmdog Club of America, where did the breed originate and how long has it existed?

- A) It originated in the United States in the 20th century.
- B) It dates back centuries in parts of Denmark, southern Sweden, and other European countries.
- C) It was developed in circuses across Europe in the 1980s.

D) It is a modern breed created recently in Scandinavia.

8. What is Carey Segebart's position within the Danish-Swedish Farmdog Club of America?

- A) She is the current treasurer.
- B) She is the club's incoming president.
- C) She is a founding member.
- D) She is a media relations officer.

9. Historically, what was the primary function of Danish-Swedish farmdogs in their native lands?

- A) Performing in circuses
- B) Herding large livestock
- C) Controlling small animals like rodents
- D) Being companions for children

10. When did kennel clubs in Denmark and Sweden officially start registering the Danish-Swedish farmdog breed?

- A) In the 20th century, before development.
- B) After 2000, once the breed became popular.
- C) In 1987.
- D) Several years ago, before AKC recognition.

11. Approximately how many Danish-Swedish farmdogs are there in the United States, and in what types of events do many of them already compete?

- A) About 202, in breed-by-breed judging.
- B) About 350, in agility, obedience, or other open sports.
- C) About 1000, mostly in circus performances.
- D) An unknown number, exclusively in best in show competitions.

12. Prior to AKC recognition, what specific type of competition were Danish-Swedish farmdogs excluded from?

- A) Agility and obedience trials.
- B) Sports open to all dogs, including mixed breeds.
- C) Traditional breed-by-breed judging for best in show prizes.
- D) Local dog shows in Iowa.

13. According to Gina DiNardo of the AKC, what kind of family is a Danish-Swedish farmdog best suited for?

- A) A family that prefers low-energy, quiet dogs.
- B) A family that lives in a small apartment without much space.
- C) A family that can provide it with necessary exercise and mental stimulation.
- D) A family interested only in show dog competitions.

14. What is the estimated waiting period for purchasing a Danish-Swedish farmdog puppy, according to Carey Segebart?

- A) A few weeks
- B) About six months
- C) Usually a year or more
- D) There is no waiting period, they are readily available.

15. What is a significant concern among fans regarding the Danish-Swedish farmdog's potential popularity, and which breed is cited as an example of similar problems?

- A) They worry it will lose its playful nature, citing the Labrador Retriever.
- B) They fear it might become too popular, leading to health problems, similar to the French bulldog.
- C) They are concerned about a decrease in demand, mentioning the German Shepherd.
- D) They believe its care will become too complex, like the Poodle.